

TEST LAB

The Gadget Jacket

BY ROGER COLLIER

Aimed at on-the-go tech lovers, the **SeV Fleece Jacket 7.0** is part of Scottevest's Technology Enabled Clothing line. It has 23 pockets ranging in size from tiny (for camera memory cards) to huge (for tablets). *US\$160, scottevest.com*



Storage

Walking is an underrated form of exercise, but it's not very exciting. Having a destination helps. For me, it's the coffee shop. I set out on a long stroll in search of espresso wearing the Scottevest fleece, which easily holds my wallet, keys, iPod touch, water bottle, notepad, pens, a magazine and a 400-page paperback. Overall it's not too heavy, and the weight is evenly distributed. Who needs a backpack?

Convenience

I find clearing the driveway of snow a pleasure, as long as I have a good podcast. But untangling a yarn-like ball of earbud cords is the pits. The jacket solved that problem. You can conceal earbuds in the jacket and pull them out of the collar when needed. The smart-phone pocket, covered in clear touch fabric, lets me navigate my audio library without removing my iPod. But with 23 pockets, finding it takes some time.

Features

The fleece has many non-tech-related features that are still pretty nifty, including a hidden pocket for travel documents, slots for pens and an elastic loop to hold a bottle. My favourite, though, is the eyeglasses pocket with tethered cleaning chamois. When I notice dust on my glasses, I now reach for my jacket instead of untucking my shirt.

BEST FOR Travellers, photographers, hikers and those who eschew the man-purse trend.

BANG FOR YOUR BUCK Medium. You're paying quite a premium for extra pockets. But if you want all your gadgets to go wherever you do, there is no garment better suited to keep them close—and separate.